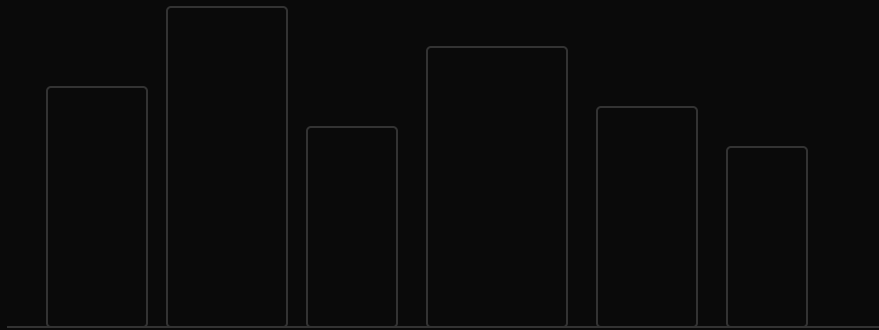


Dual-Speed Cities — Core vs Periphery

Common Cities

Rapid Decay

▼ Single-industry / transfer-payment towns



Jobless → consumption ↓ → housing ↓
→ banks fail → services vanish → youth flees

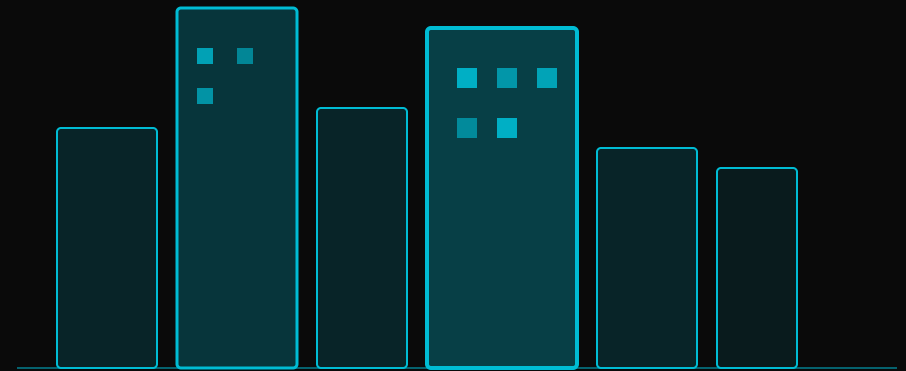
China: Hegang houses ¥20-30K · Liaoning wages ¥3-4K/mo

Prediction: 100s of ghost cities in 10 yrs

Core Cities

Transformation Not Death

▲ AI industry hubs



Population halves, GDP rises
Remaining humans + AI = hyperproductive

SF · Beijing · Shanghai · Shenzhen · New York · London

Center blazing, surrounding blocks dark and empty

"A heart still beating, but limbs gone cold"